ATEM Fleet Admin user guide

ATEM Fleet Admin **sets up a whole rig of Blackmagic ATEM switchers from one place**. You describe each switcher once in model-aware forms, then either export a loadable config folder per device or push the settable part straight down the network.

> **Before you rely on this:** "Connect & apply" writes to real switchers straight away, with no confirmation and no undo, so on a rig that's already configured, it overwrites. Live apply also **can't set everything**: three settings are always left unset afterwards, because the protocol can't reach them. And the ATEM Mini's streaming/recording XML is **reconstructed rather than verified**, because no Mini save file was available as ground truth.
>
> This project was written with AI assistance and reviewed by a human. Review it before relying on it on a live install.

Pick your run target

The same tool ships three ways, sharing all the provisioning logic:

- **Electron desktop app:** native file dialogs; macOS, Windows and Linux.
- **Web app + av-launcher tray shell:** a local Node server serving the same UI in a browser, wrapped in a menu-bar app.
- **Hosted build:** the same UI with no server behind it, at atem-fleet-admin.stoatworks-labs.com. The XML is generated in your browser tab, nothing is uploaded, and the export arrives as a `.zip`. It can't reach your LAN, so there's no **Connect & apply**; the README's What the hosted build can't do has the full list.

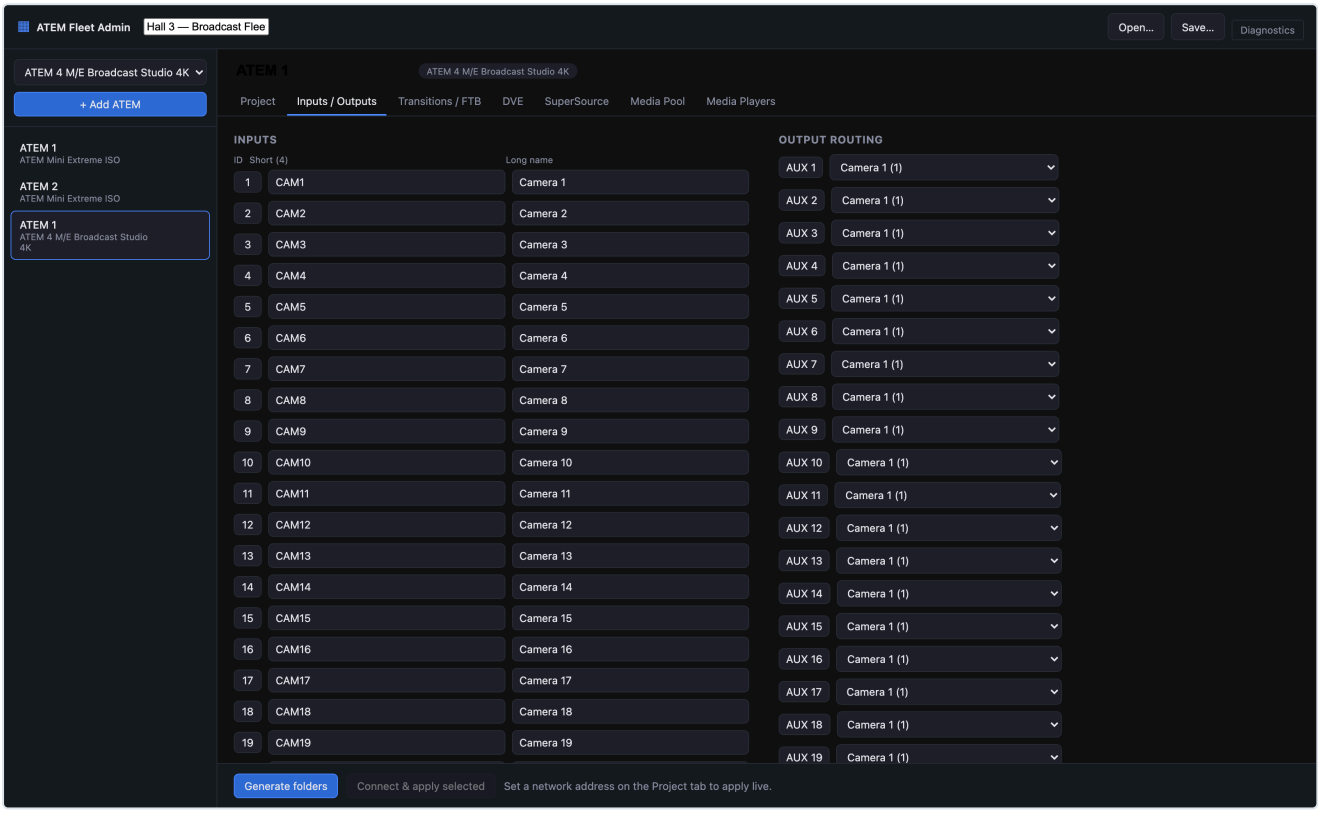
The UI is identical. **Between the desktop app and the tray, one behaviour differs, and it matters:**

	Electron	Web / tray
Open / save a fleet	native file dialog	browser download / upload
Generate folders	**you pick the directory**	**writes to the server's configured export directory, no picker**

In the web target, "Generate folders" writes files **on the machine running the server**, not the machine running the browser. The health endpoint reports where, and the UI shows it, but if you're driving it remotely, the folders aren't on your laptop.

Building a fleet

Add a switcher, pick its model, and fill in the forms. The forms are **model-aware**: you only see the tabs and options that model actually has, so an ATEM Mini Extreme doesn't offer SuperSource and a 4 M/E doesn't offer streaming.



*Note the **Short (4)** column. That's the switcher's own limit, and the reason long names get truncated.*

What the forms cover: input/output names · show/project name (the recorder filename) · recording bitrate · recording mode (program vs ISO) · output sources including UVC · SuperSource layout and sources · media pool items · media player assignments · streaming destination, key, type and bandwidth · fade-to-black · default transition time and type · DVE settings.

Two models ship: ATEM Mini Extreme ISO and ATEM 4 M/E Broadcast Studio 4K. They cover the two hardware classes; other models need a catalog entry (see DEVELOPING.md).

Path A — Generate folders

The higher-fidelity route. It writes a loadable config per device:

```
<OutputDir>/<FleetName>/<DeviceName>/config.xml
<OutputDir>/<FleetName>/<DeviceName>/Media/...
```

Drag the `Media/` files into the switcher's media pool, then use ATEM Software Control's **Load** to apply `config.xml`.

Check `mediaMissing` on every export

If a media item has no file path, or its file can't be copied, **the export doesn't fail**. The item is listed under "media missing" for that device and everything else carries on.

So a device that reports success can still have an **empty `Media/` folder**, which is what a mistyped or moved source path looks like. Check the missing list before you leave site.

Device names that sanitise alike will collide

Folder names have `< > : " / \ | ? *` and whitespace replaced with `_`, and trailing dots stripped. **`Studio 1` and `Studio/1` both become `Studio_1`, and the second overwrites the first.** There's no uniquing and no warning. Name devices distinctly.

The Mini's streaming/recording XML is unverified

There was no ATEM Mini save file to use as ground truth, so the Mini's `<Streaming>` and `<Recording>` XML elements are **reconstructed from the protocol**, and should be checked against a real Mini before you rely on them.

For those two fields, live apply is the route to trust, not the XML. The big-switcher XML *is* validated against a real autosave file.

Path B — Connect & apply

Set a network address on the Project tab and click **Connect & apply selected**. It connects, applies the settable subset, and reports a status for each setting group.

Applied live	Reported as folder-export only
Input names	**UVC / USB-C output routing**
Output routing (AUX)	**Recording bitrate / quality**
SuperSource boxes	**Media pool items**
Media player assignments	
Default transition rate	
Fade to black rate	
Streaming service	
Recording ISO mode	

> **After a completely successful live apply, three things still aren't set on the switcher:** the USB webcam routing, the recording quality, and the media pool contents. The Ethernet protocol can't reach them.
>
> The result marks those steps **skipped, not failed**, so nothing is applied silently and nothing is falsely reported as done. **Skipped isn't an error. It's a to-do.** Use the folder export for those three.

Other behaviours worth knowing:

- **Input short names are cut to 4 characters**, without warning. That's the switcher's limit.
- **The transition rate and fade-to-black rate are applied to every M/E** on the model, not just M/E 1.
- **A connection failure shows up as a single "Connect" step in error**, not as a crash, so a device that was never reached looks like a normal result with one bad row. Check `connected`.

A sensible order of operations

1. Build the fleet and save the project file.
2. **Generate folders first**, and check every device's `mediaMissing` list.
3. Load `config.xml` on each switcher via ATEM Software Control, and drag the media in.
4. Use **Connect & apply** for the settable subset when you want to push a change without walking round the rig, remembering it can't do the three skipped groups.
5. Keep the fleet project file. It's the only record of what you meant to do.

The web target has no authentication

The default is `localhost:4720`, which is safe. But the host is configurable (`ATEM_FLEET_ADMIN_HOST`), and **binding anything other than localhost exposes, with no password**:

- an endpoint that **reconfigures real switchers on your network**, and
- an endpoint that **writes files onto the host's filesystem**.

There's no token, no login and no TLS. Leave it on localhost.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause
Export succeeded but `Media/` is empty	Source files missing or unreadable — check the media-missing list; it is not an error.
A device's folder is missing or has the wrong contents	Two device names sanitised to the same folder name and one overwrote the other.
Live apply reported "skipped" rows	Expected. Those settings can't be reached over Ethernet — use the folder export.
Applied everything, USB output still wrong	UVC routing is folder-export only.
Applied everything, recording quality unchanged	Recording bitrate is folder-export only.
Input names came out truncated	Short names are cut to 4 characters — a switcher limit.
`config.xml` won't load into ATEM Software Control	Usually a model mismatch — the `product` string has to match exactly. For a Mini's streaming/recording sections, note they are unverified.
Everything reported error	Check `connected` — a failed connection shows as a single Connect step in error.
"unknown ATEM model"	The model isn't in the catalog. Two ship; others need adding.
Generated folders aren't where I expected (web target)	They are on the server's machine, under its export directory.
Tray app's helpers die silently on macOS	Only on a self-built or pre-notarisation copy — the releases are signed and notarised. Approving an unsigned `.app` does not unquarantine its bundled binaries. See `launcher/SIGNING.md`.

See also

- API.md: HTTP/IPC surfaces, the model catalog, the full apply-step table
- DEVELOPING.md: the run targets, the three tsconfigs, the catalog invariant
- README: what it does, field coverage, the two output paths